



Color Theory Essentials

Brief Overview

This note covers **Color Theory** and was created from a [5-page PDF](#). It provides an overview of **color palettes**, psychological impact, contrast types, design tools, brand examples.

Key Points

- Understand how color choices influence user perception.
- Learn the four main color harmony methods: analogous, complementary, triadic, square.
- Discover practical tools like Adobe Color and Colorhunt.
- See real-world application with the Liebe Yogurt website.



Color Theory Overview

Color Theory – the art and science of creating the right palette for a website. It ensures visual consistency and conveys the intended mood to users.

- Inconsistent palette example: brown flowers + pink paintball → *weird, confusing*.
- Flipping the palette (rearranging colors) made the design look cohesive and intentional.



Psychological Impact of Individual Colors

Color	Core Associations	Typical Uses	Caution
Red	<i>Love, energy, intensity</i>	Car advertisements (red car on red background)	May feel overly aggressive if overused
Yellow	<i>Joy, intellect, attention</i>	Headlines, logos that need to grab quick attention	Too bright for long-read backgrounds; can strain eyes

Green	<i>Freshness, growth, safety</i>	Grocery & food brands (HelloFresh, Amazon Groceries)	Works best for edible or eco-friendly products
Blue	<i>Stability, trust, serenity</i>	Financial services (PayPal, Coinbase)	Proven to increase perceived trust (e.g., shirt-color study)
Purple	<i>Royalty, wealth, femininity</i>	Payday-loan branding targeting women	Should match the brand's luxury or feminine positioning

Key takeaway: The predominant color in a design tells a story; choose it based on the message you want the user to receive.

Combining Colors

1. Analogous Palette (adjacent colors)

- **Purpose:** Harmonious, cohesive look.
- **Best for:** Navigation bars, website bodies, logo backgrounds.
- **Limitation:** Low visual “pop”; not ideal for elements that need to stand out.

2. Complementary Palette (opposite colors)

- **Purpose:** Strong contrast that makes each color pop.
- **Best for:** Logos, icons, product displays (e.g., supermarket meat aisle: red meat vs. green greenery).
- **Limitation:** Using for text + background creates a jarring, hard-to-read effect.

3. Triadic Palette (equilateral triangle on color wheel)

- **Purpose:** Balanced yet vibrant three-color scheme.
- **Best for:** Designs needing multiple accent colors without overwhelming the viewer.

4. Square Palette (four colors forming a square on the wheel)

- **Purpose:** Even distribution of contrast and harmony.
- **Best for:** Complex UI elements where several distinct colors are required.

Design tip: Limit the palette to **two or three** colors for clarity and brand consistency.

Tools & Resources

- **Adobe Color** – Interactive wheel to generate analogous, complementary, triadic, or square palettes; drag to adjust and export hex codes.
- **Colorhunt.co** – Curated collections of ready-to-use palettes; browse “hot & popular” sections for quick inspiration.

Practical step: Once a palette fits the project’s mood, copy the hex codes directly into the website’s stylesheet.

Example Application

- The **Liebe Yogurt** website employs a consistent, playful color scheme that reinforces brand identity and enhances visual appeal.

Bottom line: Align color choices with brand message, use scientifically backed combinations, and leverage online tools to streamline the palette selection process.